Galatians

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5 6

THE LETTER OF PAUL TO THE GALATIANS

Salutation

1 Paul an apostle—not from men nor through man, but through Jesus
Christ and God the Father, who raised him from the dead—[2]and all the
brethren who are with me,

To the churches of Galatia:

[3] Grace to you and peace from God the Father and our Lord Jesus Christ,
[4]who gave himself for our sins to deliver us from the present evil age,
according to the will of our God and Father; [5]to whom be the glory for ever
and ever. Amen.

There Is No Other Gospel

6 I am astonished that you are so quickly deserting him who called you in
the grace of Christ and turning to a different gospel— [*] [7]not that there is
another gospel, but there are some who trouble you and want to pervert the
gospel of Christ. [8]But even if we, or an angel from heaven, should preach to
you a gospel contrary to that which we preached to you, let him be
accursed. [9]As we have said before, so now I say again, If any one is
preaching to you a gospel contrary to that which you received, let him be
accursed.

[10] Am I now seeking the favor of men, or of God? Or am I trying to
please men? If I were still pleasing men, I should not be a servant[a] of
Christ. [*]

Paul's Vindication of His Apostleship

[11] Brethren, I would have you know that the gospel which was preached
by me is not man's[b] gospel. [12]For I did not receive it from man, nor was I
taught it, but it came through a revelation of Jesus Christ. [13]For you have
heard of my former life in Judaism, how I persecuted the Church of God
violently and tried to destroy it; [14]and I advanced in Judaism beyond many
of my own age among my people, so extremely zealous was I for the
traditions of my fathers. [15]But when he who had set me apart before I was
born, and had called me through his grace, [16]was pleased to reveal his Son
to[c] me, in order that I might preach him among the Gentiles, I did not
confer with flesh and blood, [17]nor did I go up to Jerusalem to those who
were apostles before me, but I went away into Arabia; and again I returned
to Damascus.

18 Then after three years I went up to Jerusalem to visit Ce'phas, and
remained with him fifteen days. 19But I saw none of the other apostles
except James the Lord's brother. * 20(In what I am writing to you, before
God, I do not lie!) 21Then I went into the regions of Syria and Cili'cia.
22And I was still not known by sight to the churches of Christ in Judea;
23they only heard it said, "He who once persecuted us is now preaching the
faith he once tried to destroy." 24And they glorified God because of me.

Paul and the Other Apostles

2 Then after fourteen years I went up again to Jerusalem with Barnabas,
taking Titus along with me. 2I went up by revelation; and I laid before them
(but privately before those who were of repute) the gospel which I preach
among the Gentiles, lest somehow I should be running or had run in vain.
3But even Titus, who was with me, was not compelled to be circumcised,
though he was a Greek. 4But because of false brethren secretly brought in,
who slipped in to spy out our freedom which we have in Christ Jesus, that
they might bring us into bondage—5to them we did not yield submission
even for a moment, that the truth of the gospel might be preserved for you.
6And from those who were reputed to be something (what they were makes
no difference to me; God shows no partiality)—those, I say, who were of
repute added nothing to me; 7but on the contrary, when they saw that I had
been entrusted with the gospel to the uncircumcised, just as Peter had been
entrusted with the gospel to the circumcised 8(for he who worked through
Peter for the mission to the circumcised worked through me also for the
Gentiles), 9and when they perceived the grace that was given to me, James
and Ce'phas and John, who were reputed to be pillars, gave to me and
Barnabas the right hand of fellowship, that we should go to the Gentiles and
they to the circumcised; 10only they would have us remember the poor,
which very thing I was eager to do.

Paul Rebukes Peter at Antioch

11 But when Cephas came to Antioch I opposed him to his face, because
he stood condemned. 12For before certain men came from James, he ate
with the Gentiles; but when they came he drew back and separated himself,
fearing the circumcision party. 13And with him the rest of the Jews acted
insincerely, so that even Barnabas was carried away by their insincerity.
14But when I saw that they were not straightforward about the truth of the

gospel, I said to Cephas before them all, “If you, though a Jew, live like a Gentile and not like a Jew, how can you compel the Gentiles to live like Jews?” 15We ourselves, who are Jews by birth and not Gentile sinners, 16yet who know that a man is not justified[d] by works of the law * but through faith in Jesus Christ, even we have believed in Christ Jesus, in order to be justified by faith in Christ, and not by works of the law, because by works of the law shall no flesh be justified. 17But if, in our endeavor to be justified in Christ, we ourselves were found to be sinners, is Christ then an agent of sin? Certainly not! 18But if I build up again those things which I tore down, then I prove myself a transgressor. 19For I through the law died to the law, that I might live to God. 20I have been crucified with Christ; it is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me; and the life I now live in the flesh I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me. 21I do not nullify the grace of God; for if justification[e] were through the law, then Christ died to no purpose.

Law or Faith

3 O foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched you, before whose eyes Jesus Christ was publicly portrayed as crucified? 2Let me ask you only this: Did you receive the Spirit * by works of the law, or by hearing with faith? 3Are you so foolish? Having begun with the Spirit, are you now ending with the flesh? 4Did you experience so many things in vain?—if it really is in vain. 5Does he who supplies the Spirit to you and works miracles among you do so by works of the law, or by hearing with faith?

6 Thus Abraham “believed God, and it was reckoned to him as righteousness.” 7So you see that it is men of faith who are the sons of Abraham. 8And the Scripture, foreseeing that God would justify the Gentiles by faith, preached the gospel beforehand to Abraham, saying, “In you shall all the nations be blessed.” 9So then, those who are men of faith are blessed with Abraham who had faith.

10 For all who rely on works of the law are under a curse; for it is written, “Cursed be every one who does not abide by all things written in the book of the law, and do them.” 11Now it is evident that no man is justified before God by the law; for “He who through faith is righteous shall live”;[f] 12but the law does not rest on faith, for “He who does them shall live by them.” 13Christ redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for

us—for it is written, “Cursed be every one who hangs on a tree”—[14]that in Christ Jesus the blessing of Abraham might come upon the Gentiles, that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith.

The Promise to Abraham

15 To give a human example, brethren: no one annuls even a man’s will,[g] or adds to it, once it has been ratified. [16]Now the promises were made to Abraham and to his offspring. It does not say, “And to offsprings,” referring to many; but, referring to one, “And to your offspring,” which is Christ. [17]This is what I mean: the law, which came four hundred and thirty years afterward, does not annul a covenant previously ratified by God, so as to make the promise void. [18]For if the inheritance is by the law, it is no longer by promise; but God gave it to Abraham by a promise.

The Purpose of the Law

19 Why then the law? It was added because of transgressions, till the offspring should come to whom the promise had been made; and it was ordained by angels through an intermediary. [20]Now an intermediary implies more than one; but God is one.

21 Is the law then against the promises of God? Certainly not; for if a law had been given which could make alive, then righteousness would indeed be by the law. [22]But the Scripture consigned all things to sin, that what was promised to faith in Jesus Christ might be given to those who believe.

23 Now before faith came, we were confined under the law, kept under restraint until faith should be revealed. [24]So that the law was our custodian until Christ came, that we might be justified by faith. [25]But now that faith has come, we are no longer under a custodian; [26]for in Christ Jesus you are all sons of God, through faith. [27]For as many of you as were baptized into Christ have put on Christ. [28]There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus. [29]And if you are Christ’s, then you are Abraham’s offspring, heirs according to promise.

4 I mean that the heir, as long as he is a child, is no better than a slave, though he is the owner of all the estate; [2]but he is under guardians and trustees until the date set by the father. [3]So with us; when we were children, we were slaves to the elemental spirits of the universe. [4]But when the time had fully come, God sent forth his Son, born of woman, born under the law,

5 to redeem those who were under the law, so that we might receive adoption
as sons. 6 And because you are sons, God has sent the Spirit of his Son into
our hearts, crying, "Abba! Father!" 7 So through God you are no longer a
slave but a son, and if a son then an heir.

Paul Reproves the Galatians

8 Formerly, when you did not know God, you were in bondage to beings
that by nature are no gods; 9 but now that you have come to know God, or
rather to be known by God, how can you turn back again to the weak and
beggarly elemental spirits, whose slaves you want to be once more? 10 You
observe days, and months, and seasons, and years! 11 I am afraid I have
labored over you in vain.

12 Brethren, I beg you, become as I am, for I also have become as you are.
You did me no wrong; 13 you know it was because of a bodily ailment that I
preached the gospel to you at first; 14 and though my condition was a trial to
you, you did not scorn or despise me, but received me as an angel of God,
as Christ Jesus. 15 What has become of the satisfaction you felt? For I bear
you witness that, if possible, you would have plucked out your eyes and
given them to me. 16 Have I then become your enemy by telling you the
truth?[h] 17 They make much of you, but for no good purpose; they want to
shut you out, that you may make much of them. 18 For a good purpose it is
always good to be made much of, and not only when I am present with you.
19 My little children, with whom I am again in travail until Christ be formed
in you! 20 I could wish to be present with you now and to change my tone,
for I am perplexed about you.

The Allegory of Hagar and Sarah

21 Tell me, you who desire to be under law, do you not hear the law?
22 For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one by a slave and one by a
free woman. 23 But the son of the slave was born according to the flesh, the
son of the free woman through promise. 24 Now this is an allegory: these
women are two covenants. One is from Mount Sinai, bearing children for
slavery; she is Hagar. 25 Now Hagar is Mount Sinai in Arabia;[i] she
corresponds to the present Jerusalem, for she is in slavery with her children.
26 But the Jerusalem above is free, and she is our mother. 27 For it is written,

> "Rejoice, O barren one who does not bear;
> break forth and shout, you who are not with labor pains;

for the desolate has more children
than she who has a husband."

28 Now we,[j] brethren, like Isaac, are children of promise. 29 But as at that
time he who was born according to the flesh persecuted him who was born
according to the Spirit, so it is now. 30 But what does the Scripture say?
"Cast out the slave and her son; for the son of the slave shall not inherit
with the son of the free woman." 31 So, brethren, we are not children of the
slave but of the free woman.

Christian Freedom

5 For freedom Christ has set us free; stand fast therefore, and do not
submit again to a yoke of slavery.

2 Now I, Paul, say to you that if you receive circumcision, Christ will be
of no advantage to you. 3 I testify again to every man who receives
circumcision that he is bound to keep the whole law. 4 You are severed from
Christ, you who would be justified by the law; you have fallen away from
grace. 5 For through the Spirit, by faith, we wait for the hope of
righteousness. 6 For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision
is of any avail, but faith working through love. 7 You were running well;
who hindered you from obeying the truth? 8 This persuasion is not from him
who called you. 9 A little leaven leavens all the dough. 10 I have confidence
in the Lord that you will take no other view than mine; and he who is
troubling you will bear his judgment, whoever he is. 11 But if I, brethren,
still preach circumcision, why am I still persecuted? In that case the
stumbling block of the cross * has been removed. 12 I wish those who
unsettle you would mutilate themselves!

13 For you were called to freedom, brethren; only do not use your
freedom as an opportunity for the flesh, but through love be servants of one
another. 14 For the whole law is fulfilled in one word, "You shall love your
neighbor as yourself." 15 But if you bite and devour one another take heed
that you are not consumed by one another.

The Works of the Fleshand the Fruit of the Spirit

16 But I say, walk by the Spirit, and do not gratify the desires of the flesh.
17 For the desires of the flesh are against the Spirit, and the desires of the
Spirit are against the flesh; for these are opposed to each other, to prevent
you from doing what you would. 18 But if you are led by the Spirit you are

not under the law. [19]Now the works of the flesh are plain: immorality, impurity, licentiousness, [20]idolatry, sorcery, enmity, strife, jealousy, anger, selfishness, dissension, party spirit, [21]envy,[k] drunkenness, carousing, and the like. I warn you, as I warned you before, that those who do such things shall not inherit the kingdom of God. [22]But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, [23]gentleness, self-control; against such there is no law. [24]And those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires.

25 If we live by the Spirit, let us also walk by the Spirit. [26]Let us have no self-conceit, no provoking of one another, no envy of one another.

Bear One Another's Burdens

6 Brethren, if a man is overtaken in any trespass, you who are spiritual should restore him in a spirit of gentleness. Look to yourself, lest you too be tempted. [2]Bear one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ. [3]For if any one thinks he is something, when he is nothing, he deceives himself. [4]But let each one test his own work, and then his reason to boast will be in himself alone and not in his neighbor. [5]For each man will have to bear his own load.

6 Let him who is taught the word share all good things with him who teaches.

7 Do not be deceived; God is not mocked, for whatever a man sows, that he will also reap. [8]For he who sows to his own flesh will from the flesh reap corruption; but he who sows to the Spirit will from the Spirit reap eternal life. [9]And let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due season we shall reap, if we do not lose heart. [10]So then, as we have opportunity, let us do good to all men, and especially to those who are of the household of faith.

Final Admonitions and Benediction

[11] See with what large letters I am writing to you with my own hand. [12]It is those who want to make a good showing in the flesh that would compel you to be circumcised, and only in order that they may not be persecuted for the cross of Christ. [13]For even those who receive circumcision do not themselves keep the law, but they desire to have you circumcised that they may glory in your flesh. [14]But far be it from me to glory except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, by which[l] the world has been crucified to me, and I to the world. [15]For neither circumcision counts for anything, nor

uncircumcision, but a new creation. [16]Peace and mercy be upon all who walk by this rule, upon the Israel of God.

17 Henceforth let no man trouble me; for I bear on my body the marks of Jesus.

18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit, brethren. Amen.

Ephesians

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5 6

THE LETTER OF PAUL TO THE EPHESIANS

Salutation

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God,

To the saints who are * also faithful[a] in Christ Jesus:
2 Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Spiritual Blessings in Christ

3 Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed
us in Christ with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly places, **4**even as he
chose us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy
and blameless before him. **5**He destined us in love[b] to be his sons through
Jesus Christ, according to the purpose of his will, **6**to the praise of his
glorious grace which he freely bestowed on us in the Beloved. **7**In him we
have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses,
according to the riches of his grace **8**which he lavished upon us. **9**For he has
made known to us in all wisdom and insight the mystery of his will,
according to his purpose which he set forth in Christ **10**as a plan for the
fulness of time, to unite * all things in him, things in heaven and things on
earth.
11 In him, according to the purpose of him who accomplishes all things
according to the counsel of his will, **12**we who first hoped in Christ have
been destined and appointed to live for the praise of his glory. **13**In him you
also, who have heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation, and
have believed in him, were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit, **14**who is
the guarantee of our inheritance until we acquire possession of it, to the
praise of his glory.

Paul's Prayer

15 For this reason, because I have heard of your faith in the Lord Jesus
and your love[c] toward all the saints, **16**I do not cease to give thanks for you,
remembering you in my prayers, **17**that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ,
the Father of glory, may give you a spirit of wisdom and of revelation in the
knowledge of him, **18**having the eyes of your hearts enlightened, that you
may know what is the hope to which he has called you, what are the riches
of his glorious inheritance in the saints, **19**and what is the immeasurable
greatness of his power in us who believe, according to the working of his
great might **20**which he accomplished in Christ when he raised him from the

dead and made him sit at his right hand in the heavenly places, [21]far above
all rule and authority and power and dominion, and above every name that
is named, not only in this age but also in that which is to come; [22]and he has
put all things under his feet and has made him the head over all things for
the Church, [23]which is his body, the fulness of him who fills all in all.

From Death to Life with Christ

2 And you he made alive, when you were dead through the trespasses
and sins [2]in which you once walked, following the course of this world,
following the prince of the power of the air, the spirit that is now at work in
the sons of disobedience. [3]Among these we all once lived in the passions of
our flesh, following the desires of body and mind, and so we were by nature
children of wrath, like the rest of mankind. [4]But God, who is rich in mercy,
out of the great love with which he loved us, [5]even when we were dead
through our trespasses, made us alive together with Christ (by grace you
have been saved), [6]and raised us up with him, and made us sit with him in
the heavenly places in Christ Jesus, [7]that in the coming ages he might show
the immeasurable riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.
[8]For by grace you have been saved through faith; and this is not your own
doing, it is the gift of God—[9]not because of works, lest any man should
boast. [10]For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good
works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them.

One in Christ

11 Therefore remember that at one time you Gentiles in the flesh, called
the uncircumcision by what is called the circumcision, which is made in the
flesh by hands—[12]remember that you were at that time separated from
Christ, alienated from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers to the
covenants of promise, having no hope and without God in the world. [13]But
now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near in
the blood of Christ. [14]For he is our peace, who has made us both one, and
has broken down the dividing wall * of hostility, [15]by abolishing in his flesh
the law of commandments and ordinances, that he might create in himself
one new man in place of the two, so making peace, [16]and might reconcile us
both to God in one body through the cross, thereby bringing the hostility to
an end. [17]And he came and preached peace to you who were far off and
peace to those who were near; [18]for through him we both have access in one

Spirit to the Father. [19]So then you are no longer strangers and sojourners,
but you are fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of
God, [20]built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus
himself being the cornerstone, [21]in whom the whole structure is joined
together and grows into a holy temple in the Lord; [22]in whom you also are
built into it for a dwelling place of God in the Spirit.

Paul's Ministry to the Gentiles

3 For this reason I, Paul, a prisoner for Christ Jesus on behalf of you
Gentiles—[2]assuming that you have heard of the stewardship of God's grace
that was given to me for you, [3]how the mystery * was made known to me
by revelation, as I have written briefly. [4]When you read this you can
perceive my insight into the mystery of Christ, [5]which was not made known
to the sons of men in other generations as it has now been revealed to his
holy apostles and prophets by the Spirit; [6]that is, how the Gentiles are
fellow heirs, members of the same body, and partakers of the promise in
Christ Jesus through the gospel.

7 Of this gospel I was made a minister according to the gift of God's grace
which was given me by the working of his power. [8]To me, though I am the
very least of all the saints, this grace was given, to preach to the Gentiles
the unsearchable riches of Christ, [9]and to make all men see what is the plan
of the mystery hidden for ages in[d] God who created all things; [10]that
through the Church the manifold wisdom of God might now be made
known to the principalities and powers in the heavenly places. [11]This was
according to the eternal purpose which he has realized in Christ Jesus our
Lord, [12]in whom we have boldness and confidence of access through our
faith in him. [13]So I ask you not to[e] lose heart over what I am suffering for
you, which is your glory.

Prayer for the Ephesians

14 For this reason I bow my knees before the Father, [15]from whom every
family in heaven and on earth is named, [16]that according to the riches of his
glory he may grant you to be strengthened with might through his Spirit in
the inner man, [17]and that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith; that
you, being rooted and grounded in love, [18]may have power to comprehend
with all the saints what is the breadth and length and height and depth,

19 and to know the love of Christ which surpasses knowledge, that you may
be filled with all the fulness of God.

20 Now to him who by the power at work within us is able to do far more
abundantly than all that we ask or think, 21 to him be glory in the Church
and in Christ Jesus to all generations, for ever and ever. Amen.

Unity in the Body of Christ

4 I therefore, a prisoner for the Lord, beg you to walk in a manner
worthy of the calling to which you have been called, 2 with all lowliness and
meekness, with patience, forbearing one another in love, 3 eager to maintain
the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace. 4 There is one body and one
Spirit, just as you were called to the one hope that belongs to your call, 5 one
Lord, one faith, one baptism, 6 one God and Father of us all, who is above
all and through all and in all. 7 But grace was given to each of us according
to the measure of Christ's gift. 8 Therefore it is said,

"When he ascended on high he led a host of captives,
and he gave gifts to men."

9 (In saying, "He ascended," what does it mean but that he had also
descended into the lower parts of the earth? 10 He who descended is he who
also ascended far above all the heavens, that he might fill all things.) 11 And
his gifts were that some should be apostles, some prophets, some
evangelists, some pastors and teachers, 12 to equip the saints for the work of
ministry, for building up the body of Christ, 13 until we all attain to the unity
of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to mature manhood, to
the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ; 14 so that we may no
longer be children, tossed back and forth and carried about with every wind
of doctrine, by the cunning of men, by their craftiness in deceitful wiles.
15 Rather, speaking the truth in love, we are to grow up in every way into
him who is the head, into Christ, 16 from whom the whole body, joined and
knit together by every joint with which it is supplied, when each part is
working properly, makes bodily growth and upbuilds itself in love.

The Old Life and the New

17 Now this I affirm and testify in the Lord, that you must no longer walk
as the Gentiles walk, in the futility of their minds; 18 they are darkened in
their understanding, alienated from the life of God because of the ignorance
that is in them, due to their hardness of heart; 19 they have become callous

and have given themselves up to licentiousness, greedy to practice every kind of uncleanness. [20]You did not so learn Christ! —[21]assuming that you have heard about him and were taught in him, as the truth is in Jesus. [22]Put off the old man that belongs to your former manner of life and is corrupt through deceitful lusts, [23]and be renewed in the spirit of your minds, [24]and put on the new man, created after the likeness of God in true righteousness and holiness.

Rules for the New Life

25 Therefore, putting away falsehood, let every one speak the truth with his neighbor, for we are members one of another. [26]Be angry but do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, [27]and give no opportunity to the devil. [28]Let the thief no longer steal, but rather let him labor, doing honest work with his hands, so that he may be able to give to those in need. [29]Let no evil talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for edifying, as fits the occasion, that it may impart grace to those who hear. [30]And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, in whom you were sealed for the day of redemption. [31]Let all bitterness and wrath and anger and clamor and slander be put away from you, with all malice, [32]and be kind to one another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, as God in Christ forgave you.

5 Therefore be imitators of God, as beloved children. [2]And walk in love, as Christ loved us and gave himself up for us, a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God.

Renounce Pagan Ways

3 But immorality and all impurity or covetousness must not even be named among you, as is fitting among saints. [4]Let there be no filthiness, nor silly talk, nor levity, which are not fitting; but instead let there be thanksgiving. [5]Be sure of this, that no immoral or impure man, or one who is covetous (that is, an idolater), has any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God. [6]Let no one deceive you with empty words, for it is because of these things that the wrath of God comes upon the sons of disobedience. [7]Therefore do not associate with them, [8]for once you were darkness, but now you are light in the Lord; walk as children of light [9](for the fruit of light is found in all that is good and right and true), [10]and try to learn what is pleasing to the Lord. [11]Take no part in the unfruitful works of darkness, but instead expose them. [12]For it is a shame even to speak of the

things that they do in secret; [13]but when anything is exposed by the light it becomes visible, for anything that becomes visible is light. [14]Therefore it is said,

"Awake, O sleeper, and arise from the dead,
and Christ shall give you light." *

15 Look carefully then how you walk, not as unwise men but as wise, [16]making the most of the time, because the days are evil. [17]Therefore do not be foolish, but understand what the will of the Lord is. [18]And do not get drunk with wine, for that is debauchery; but be filled with the Spirit, [19]addressing one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody to the Lord with all your heart, [20]always and for everything giving thanks in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ to God the Father.

The Christian Household

21 Be subject to one another out of reverence for Christ. [22]Wives, be subject to your husbands, as to the Lord. [23]For the husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the Church, his body, and is himself its Savior. [24]As the Church is subject to Christ, so let wives also be subject in everything to their husbands. [25]Husbands, love your wives, as Christ loved the Church and gave himself up for her, [26]that he might sanctify her, having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word, [27]that he might present the Church to himself in splendor, without spot or wrinkle or any such thing, that she might be holy and without blemish. [28]Even so husbands should love their wives as their own bodies. He who loves his wife loves himself. [29]For no man ever hates his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it, as Christ does the Church, [30]because we are members of his body. [31]"For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh." [32]This is a great mystery, and I mean in reference to Christ and the Church; [33]however, let each one of you love his wife as himself, and let the wife see that she respects her husband.

Children and Parents

6 Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right. [2]"Honor your father and mother" (this is the first commandment with a promise), [3]"that it may be well with you and that you may live long on the earth." [4]Fathers, do

not provoke your children to anger, but bring them up in the discipline and instruction of the Lord.

Slaves and Masters

5 Slaves, be obedient to those who are your earthly masters, with fear and trembling, in singleness of heart, as to Christ; **6**not in the way of eye-service, as men-pleasers, but as servants[f] of Christ, doing the will of God from the heart, **7**rendering service with a good will as to the Lord and not to men, **8**knowing that whatever good any one does, he will receive the same again from the Lord, whether he is a slave or free. **9**Masters, do the same to them, and forbear threatening, knowing that he who is both their Master and yours is in heaven, and that there is no partiality with him.

The Whole Armor of God

10 Finally, be strong in the Lord and in the strength of his might. **11**Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. **12**For we are not contending against flesh and blood, but against the principalities, against the powers, against the world rulers of this present darkness, against the spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places. **13**Therefore take the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand. **14**Stand therefore, having fastened the belt of truth around your waist, and having put on the breastplate of righteousness, **15**and having shod your feet with the equipment of the gospel of peace; **16**besides all these, taking the shield of faith, with which you can quench all the flaming darts of the Evil One. **17**And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God. **18**Pray at all times in the Spirit, with all prayer and supplication. To that end keep alert with all perseverance, making supplication for all the saints, **19**and also for me, that utterance may be given me in opening my mouth boldly to proclaim the mystery of the gospel, **20**for which I am an ambassador in chains; that I may declare it boldly, as I ought to speak.

Personal Matters and Benediction

21 Now that you also may know how I am and what I am doing, Tych'icus the beloved brother and faithful minister in the Lord will tell you everything. **22**I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know how we are, and that he may encourage your hearts.

23 Peace be to the brethren, and love with faith, from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. **24**Grace be with all who love our Lord Jesus Christ with love undying.

Philippians

Chapters

1 2 3 4

THE LETTER OF PAUL TO THE PHILIPPIANS

Salutation

1 Paul and Timothy, servants[a] of Christ Jesus,

To all the saints in Christ Jesus who are at Philip'pi, with the bishops[b] and deacons:

2 Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Paul's Prayer for the Philippians

3 I thank my God in all my remembrance of you, 4always in every prayer of mine for you all making my prayer with joy, 5thankful for your partnership in the gospel from the first day until now. 6And I am sure that he who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ. 7It is right for me to feel this way about you all, because I hold you in my heart, for you are all partakers with me of grace, both in my imprisonment and in the defense and confirmation of the gospel. 8For God is my witness, how I yearn for you all with the affection of Christ Jesus. 9And it is my prayer that your love may abound more and more, with knowledge and all discernment, 10so that you may approve what is excellent, and may be pure and blameless for the day of Christ, 11filled with the fruits of righteousness which come through Jesus Christ, to the glory and praise of God.

Paul's Present Circumstances

12 I want you to know, brethren, that what has happened to me has really served to advance the gospel, 13so that it has become known throughout the whole praetorian guard[c] and to all the rest that my imprisonment is for Christ; 14and most of the brethren have been made confident in the Lord because of my imprisonment, * and are much more bold to speak the word of God without fear.

15 Some indeed preach Christ from envy and rivalry, but others from good will. 16The latter do it out of love, knowing that I am put here for the defense of the gospel; 17the former proclaim Christ out of partisanship, not sincerely but thinking to afflict me in my imprisonment. 18What then? Only that in every way, whether in pretense or in truth, Christ is proclaimed; and in that I rejoice.

To Live Is Christ

19 Yes, and I shall rejoice. For I know that through your prayers and the
help of the Spirit of Jesus Christ this will turn out for my deliverance, 20as it
is my eager expectation and hope that I shall not be at all ashamed, but that
with full courage now as always Christ will be honored in my body, *
whether by life or by death. 21For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.
22If it is to be life in the flesh, that means fruitful labor for me. Yet which I
shall choose I cannot tell. 23I am hard pressed between the two. My desire is
to depart and be with Christ, for that is far better. 24But to remain in the
flesh is more necessary on your account. 25Convinced of this, I know that I
shall remain and continue with you all, for your progress and joy in the
faith, 26so that in me you may have ample cause to glory in Christ Jesus,
because of my coming to you again.
27 Only let your manner of life be worthy of the gospel of Christ, so that
whether I come and see you or am absent, I may hear of you that you stand
firm in one spirit, with one mind striving side by side for the faith of the
gospel, 28and not frightened in anything by your opponents. This is a clear
omen to them of their destruction, but of your salvation, and that from God.
29For it has been granted to you that for the sake of Christ you should not
only believe in him but also suffer for his sake, 30engaged in the same
conflict which you saw and now hear to be mine.

Imitating Christ's Humility

2 So if there is any encouragement in Christ, any incentive of love, any
participation in the Spirit, any affection and sympathy, 2complete my joy by
being of the same mind, having the same love, being in full accord and of
one mind. 3Do nothing from selfishness or conceit, but in humility count
others better than yourselves. 4Let each of you look not only to his own
interests, but also to the interests of others. 5Have this mind among
yourselves, which was in Christ Jesus, 6who, though he was in the form of
God, * did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped, 7but emptied
himself, * taking the form of a servant,d being born in the likeness of men.
8And being found in human form he humbled himself and became obedient
unto death, even death on a cross. 9Therefore God has highly exalted him
and bestowed on him the name which is above every name, 10that at the
name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the

earth, [11]and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.

Shining as Lights in the World

12 Therefore, my beloved, as you have always obeyed, so now, not only as in my presence but much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling; [13]for God is at work in you, both to will and to work for his good pleasure.

14 Do all things without grumbling or questioning, [15]that you may be blameless and innocent, children of God without blemish in the midst of a crooked and perverse generation, among whom you shine as lights in the world, [16]holding fast the word of life, so that in the day of Christ I may be proud that I did not run in vain or labor in vain. [17]Even if I am to be poured as a libation upon the sacrificial offering of your faith, I am glad and rejoice with you all. [18]Likewise you also should be glad and rejoice with me.

Timothy and Epaphroditus

19 I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy to you soon, so that I may be cheered by news of you. [20]I have no one like him, who will be genuinely anxious for your welfare. [21]They all look after their own interests, not those of Jesus Christ. [22]But Timothy's worth you know, how as a son with a father he has served with me in the gospel. [23]I hope therefore to send him just as soon as I see how it will go with me; [24]and I trust in the Lord that shortly I myself shall come also.

25 I have thought it necessary to send to you Epaphrodi'tus my brother and fellow worker and fellow soldier, and your messenger and minister to my need, [26]for he has been longing for you all, and has been distressed because you heard that he was ill. [27]Indeed he was ill, near to death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but on me also, lest I should have sorrow upon sorrow. [28]I am the more eager to send him, therefore, that you may rejoice at seeing him again, and that I may be less anxious. [29]So receive him in the Lord with all joy; and honor such men, [30]for he nearly died for the work of Christ, risking his life to complete your service to me.

Loss of All to Gain Christ

3 Finally, my brethren, rejoice in the Lord. To write the same things to you is not irksome to me, and is safe for you.

2 Look out for the dogs, look out for the evil-workers, look out for those who mutilate the flesh. [3]For we are the true circumcision, who worship God in spirit,[e] and glory in Christ Jesus, and put no confidence in the flesh. [4]Though I myself have reason for confidence in the flesh also. If any other man thinks he has reason for confidence in the flesh, I have more: [5]circumcised on the eighth day, of the people of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, a Hebrew born of Hebrews; as to the law a Pharisee, [6]as to zeal a persecutor of the Church, as to righteousness under the law blameless. [7]But whatever gain I had, I counted as loss for the sake of Christ. [8]Indeed I count everything as loss because of the surpassing worth of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord. For his sake I have suffered the loss of all things, and count them as refuse, in order that I may gain Christ [9]and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own, based on law, but that which is through faith in Christ, the righteousness from God that depends on faith; [10]that I may know him and the power of his resurrection, and may share his sufferings, becoming like him in his death, [11]that if possible I may attain the resurrection from the dead.

Pressing toward the Goal

12 Not that I have already obtained this or am already perfect; but I press on to make it my own, because Christ Jesus has made me his own. * [13]Brethren, I do not consider that I have made it my own; but one thing I do, forgetting what lies behind and straining forward to what lies ahead, [14]I press on toward the goal for the prize of the upward call of God in Christ Jesus. [15]Let those of us who are mature be thus minded; and if in anything you are otherwise minded, God will reveal that also to you. [16]Only let us hold true to what we have attained.

17 Brethren, join in imitating me, and mark those who so walk as you have an example in us. [18]For many, of whom I have often told you and now tell you even with tears, walk as enemies of the cross of Christ. [19]Their end is destruction, their god is the belly, and they glory in their shame, with minds set on earthly things. § [20]But our commonwealth is in heaven, and from it we await a Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ, [21]who will change our lowly body to be like his glorious body, by the power which enables him even to subject all things to himself.

Exhortations

4 Therefore, my brethren, whom I love and long for, my joy and crown,
stand firm in this way in the Lord, my beloved.

2 I entreat Eu-o'dia and I entreat Syn'tyche to agree in the Lord. [3]And I
also ask you, who are a true co-worker, help these women, for they have
labored side by side with me in the gospel together with Clement and the
rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the book of life.

4 Rejoice in the Lord always; again I will say, Rejoice. [5]Let all men know
your forbearance. The Lord is at hand. [6]Have no anxiety about anything,
but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your
requests be made known to God. [7]And the peace of God, which passes all
understanding, will keep your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

8 Finally, brethren, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is
just, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is gracious, if there is
any excellence, if there is anything worthy of praise, think about these
things. [9]What you have learned and received and heard and seen in me, do;
and the God of peace will be with you.

Acknowledgment of the Philippians' Gifts

10 I rejoice in the Lord greatly that now at length you have revived your
concern for me; you were indeed concerned for me, but you had no
opportunity. [11]Not that I complain of want; for I have learned, in whatever
state I am, to be content. [12]I know how to be abased, and I know how to
abound; in any and all circumstances I have learned the secret of facing
plenty and hunger, abundance and want. [13]I can do all things in him who
strengthens me.

14 Yet it was kind of you to share my trouble. [15]And you Philippians
yourselves know that in the beginning of the gospel, when I left Macedonia,
no church entered into partnership with me in giving and receiving except
you only; [16]for even in Thessaloni'ca you sent me help[f] once and again.
[17]Not that I seek the gift; but I seek the fruit which increases to your credit.
[18]I have received full payment, and more; I am filled, having received from
Epaphrodi'tus the gifts you sent, a fragrant offering, a sacrifice acceptable
and pleasing to God. [19]And my God will supply every need of yours
according to his riches in glory in Christ Jesus. [20]To our God and Father be
glory for ever and ever. Amen.

Final Greetings and Benediction

21 Greet every saint in Christ Jesus. The brethren who are with me greet you. **22**All the saints greet you, especially those of Caesar’s household.
23 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.

Colossians

Chapters

1 2 3 4

THE LETTER OF PAUL TO THE COLOSSIANS

Salutation

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and Timothy our
brother,
2 To the saints and faithful brethren in Christ at Colos'sae:
Grace to you and peace from God our Father.

Gratitude for the Colossians' Faith

3 We always thank God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, when we
pray for you, 4because we have heard of your faith in Christ Jesus and of
the love which you have for all the saints, 5because of the hope laid up for
you in heaven. Of this you have heard before in the word of the truth, the
gospel 6which has come to you, as indeed in the whole world it is bearing
fruit and growing—so among yourselves, from the day you heard and
understood the grace of God in truth, 7as you learned it from Ep'aphras our
beloved fellow servant. He is a faithful minister of Christ on our[a] behalf
8and has made known to us your love in the Spirit.
9 And so, from the day we heard of it, we have not ceased to pray for you,
asking that you may be filled with the knowledge of his will in all spiritual
wisdom and understanding, 10to lead a life worthy of the Lord, fully
pleasing to him, bearing fruit in every good work and increasing in the
knowledge of God. 11May you be strengthened with all power, according to
his glorious might, for all endurance and patience with joy, 12giving thanks
to the Father, who has qualified us[b] to share in the inheritance of the saints
in light. 13He has delivered us from the dominion of darkness and
transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son, 14in whom we have
redemption, the forgiveness of sins.

The Supremacy of Christ

15 He is the image of the invisible God, the first-born * of all creation;
16for in him all things were created, in heaven and on earth, visible and
invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or authorities—all
things were created through him and for him. 17He is before all things, and
in him all things hold together. 18He is the head of the body, the Church; he
is the beginning, the first-born from the dead, that in everything he * might
be pre-eminent. 19For in him all the fulness of God was pleased to dwell,

[20]and through him to reconcile to himself all things, whether on earth or in heaven, making peace by the blood of his cross.

21 And you, who once were estranged and hostile in mind, doing evil deeds, [22]he has now reconciled in his body of flesh by his death, in order to present you holy and blameless and irreproachable before him, [23]provided that you continue in the faith, stable and steadfast, not shifting from the hope of the gospel which you heard, which has been preached to every creature under heaven, and of which I, Paul, became a minister.

Paul's Sufferings and Ministry

24 Now I rejoice in my sufferings for your sake, and in my flesh I complete what is lacking * in Christ's afflictions for the sake of his body, that is, the Church, [25]of which I became a minister according to the divine office which was given to me for you, to make the word of God fully known, [26]the mystery hidden for ages and generations[c] but now made manifest to his saints. [27]To them God chose to make known how great among the Gentiles are the riches of the glory of this mystery, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory. [28]Him we proclaim, warning every man and teaching every man in all wisdom, that we may present every man mature in Christ. [29]For this I toil, striving with all the energy which he mightily inspires within me.

2 For I want you to know how greatly I strive for you, and for those at La-odice'a, and for all who have not seen my face, [2]that their hearts may be encouraged as they are knit together in love, to have all the riches of assured understanding and the knowledge of God's mystery, of Christ, [3]in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge. [4]I say this in order that no one may delude you with beguiling speech. [5]For though I am absent in body, yet I am with you in spirit, rejoicing to see your good order and the firmness of your faith in Christ.

Fulness of Life in Christ

6 As therefore you received Christ Jesus the Lord, so live in him, [7]rooted and built up in him and established in the faith, just as you were taught, abounding in thanksgiving.

Warnings against False Teachers

8 See to it that no one makes a prey of you by philosophy and empty deceit, according to human tradition, according to the elemental spirits of

the universe, and not according to Christ. 9For in him the whole fulness of deity dwells bodily, 10and you have come to fulness of life in him, who is the head of all rule and authority. 11In him also you were circumcised with a circumcision made without hands, by putting off the body of flesh in the circumcision of Christ; 12and you were buried with him in baptism, in which you were also raised with him through faith in the working of God, who raised him from the dead. 13And you, who were dead in trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh, God made alive together with him, having forgiven us all our trespasses, 14having canceled the bond which stood against us with its legal demands; this he set aside, nailing it to the cross. 15He disarmed the principalities and powers and made a public example of them, triumphing over them in him.[d]

16 Therefore let no one pass judgment on you in questions of food and drink or with regard to a festival or a new moon or a sabbath. 17These are only a shadow of what is to come; but the substance belongs to Christ. 18Let no one disqualify you, insisting on self-abasement and worship of angels, taking his stand on visions, puffed up without reason by his sensuous mind, 19and not holding fast to the Head, from whom the whole body, nourished and knit together through its joints and ligaments, grows with a growth that is from God.

20 If with Christ you died to the elemental spirits of the universe, why do you live as if you still belonged to the world? Why do you submit to regulations, 21"Do not handle, Do not taste, Do not touch" 22(referring to things which all perish as they are used), according to human precepts and doctrines? 23These have indeed an appearance of wisdom in promoting rigor of devotion and self-abasement and severity to the body, but they are of no value in checking the indulgence of the flesh.[e]

New Life in Christ

3 If then you have been raised with Christ, seek the things that are above, where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God. 2Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are on earth. 3For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God. 4When Christ who is our life appears, then you also will appear with him in glory.

5 Put to death therefore what is earthly in you: immorality, impurity, passion, evil desire, and covetousness, which is idolatry. 6On account of

these the wrath of God is coming.[f] 7In these you once walked, when you lived in them. 8But now put them all away: anger, wrath, malice, slander, and foul talk from your mouth. 9Do not lie to one another, seeing that you have put off the old man with his practices 10and have put on the new man, who is being renewed in knowledge after the image of his creator. 11Here there cannot be Greek and Jew, circumcised and uncircumcised, barbarian, Scyth'ian, slave, free man, but Christ is all, and in all.

12 Put on then, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, compassion, kindness, lowliness, meekness, and patience, 13forbearing one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive. 14And over all these put on love, which binds everything together in perfect harmony. 15And let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, to which indeed you were called in the one body. And be thankful. 16Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly, as you teach and admonish one another in all wisdom, and as you sing psalms and hymns and spiritual songs with thankfulness in your hearts to God. 17And whatever you do, in word or deed, do everything in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through him.

Rules for Christian Households

18 * Wives, be subject to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord. 19Husbands, love your wives, and do not be harsh with them. 20Children, obey your parents in everything, for this pleases the Lord. 21Fathers, do not provoke your children, lest they become discouraged. 22Slaves, obey in everything those who are your earthly masters, not with eyeservice, as men-pleasers, but in singleness of heart, fearing the Lord. 23Whatever your task, work heartily, as serving the Lord and not men, 24knowing that from the Lord you will receive the inheritance as your reward; you are serving the Lord Christ. 25For the wrongdoer will be paid back for the wrong he has done, and there is no partiality.

4 Masters, treat your slaves justly and fairly, knowing that you also have a Master in heaven.

Further Instructions

2 Continue steadfastly in prayer, being watchful in it with thanksgiving; 3and pray for us also, that God may open to us a door for the word, to

declare the mystery of Christ, on account of which I am in prison, [4]that I may make it clear, as I ought to speak.

5 Conduct yourselves wisely toward outsiders, making the most of the time. [6]Let your speech always be gracious, seasoned with salt, so that you may know how you ought to answer every one.

Final Greetings and Benediction

7 Tych'icus will tell you all about my affairs; he is a beloved brother and faithful minister and fellow servant in the Lord. [8]I have sent him to you for this very purpose, that you may know how we are and that he may encourage your hearts, [9]and with him Ones'imus, the faithful and beloved brother, who is one of yourselves. They will tell you of everything that has taken place here.

10 Aristar'chus my fellow prisoner greets you, and Mark the cousin of Barnabas * (concerning whom you have received instructions—if he comes to you, receive him), [11]and Jesus who is called Justus. These are the only men of the circumcision among my fellow workers for the kingdom of God, and they have been a comfort to me. [12]Ep'aphras, who is one of yourselves, a servant[g] of Christ Jesus, greets you, always remembering you earnestly in his prayers, that you may stand mature and fully assured in all the will of God. [13]For I bear him witness that he has worked hard for you and for those in La-odice'a and in Hi-erap'olis. [14]Luke the beloved physician * and Demas greet you. [15]Give my greetings to the brethren at La-odice'a, and to Nympha and the church in her house. [16]And when this letter has been read among you, have it read also in the Church of the La-odice'ans; and see that you read also the letter from La-odice'a. [17]And say to Archip'pus, “See that you fulfil the ministry which you have received in the Lord.”

18 I, Paul, write this greeting with my own hand. Remember my chains. Grace be with you.

1 Thessalonians

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5

THE FIRST LETTER OF PAUL TO THE THESSALONIANS

Salutation

1 Paul, Silva'nus, and Timothy, *

To the Church of the Thessalo'nians in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:

Grace to you and peace.

The Thessalonians' Faith and Example

2 We give thanks to God always for you all, constantly mentioning you in
our prayers, 3remembering before our God and Father your work of faith
and labor of love and steadfastness of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ. 4For
we know, brethren beloved by God, that he has chosen you; 5for our gospel
came to you not only in word, but also in power and in the Holy Spirit and
with full conviction. You know what kind of men we proved to be among
you for your sake. 6And you became imitators of us and of the Lord, for
you received the word in much affliction, with joy inspired by the Holy
Spirit; 7so that you became an example to all the believers in Macedonia
and in Acha'ia. 8For not only has the word of the Lord sounded forth from
you in Macedonia and Acha'ia, but your faith in God has gone forth
everywhere, so that we need not say anything. 9For they themselves report
concerning us what a welcome we had among you, and how you turned to
God from idols, to serve a living and true God, 10and to wait for his Son
from heaven, whom he raised from the dead, Jesus who delivers us from the
wrath to come.

Paul's Ministry in Thessalonica

2 For you yourselves know, brethren, that our visit to you was not in
vain; 2but though we had already suffered and been shamefully treated at
Philip'pi, as you know, we had courage in our God to declare to you the
gospel of God in the face of great opposition. 3For our appeal does not
spring from error or uncleanness, nor is it made with guile; 4but just as we
have been approved by God to be entrusted with the gospel, so we speak,
not to please men, but to please God who tests our hearts. 5For we never
used either words of flattery, as you know, or a cloak for greed, as God is
witness; 6nor did we seek glory from men, whether from you or from
others, though we might have made demands as apostles of Christ. 7But we
were gentle[a] among you, like a nurse taking care of her children. 8So, being

affectionately desirous of you, we were ready to share with you not only the gospel of God but also our own selves, because you had become very dear to us.

9 For you remember our labor and toil, brethren; we worked night and day, that we might not burden any of you, while we preached to you the gospel of God. **10**You are witnesses, and God also, how holy and righteous and blameless was our behavior to you believers; **11**for you know how, like a father with his children, we exhorted each one of you and encouraged you and charged you **12**to walk in a manner worthy of God, who calls you into his own kingdom and glory.

13 And we also thank God constantly for this, that when you received the word of God which you heard from us, you accepted it not as the word of men but as what it really is, the word of God, which is at work in you believers. **14**For you, brethren, became imitators of the churches of God in Christ Jesus which are in Judea; for you suffered the same things from your own countrymen as they did from the Jews, **15**who killed both the Lord Jesus and the prophets, and drove us out, and displease God and oppose all men **16**by hindering us from speaking to the Gentiles that they may be saved —so as always to fill up the measure of their sins. But God's wrath has come upon them at last![b]

Paul's Desire to Visitthe Thessalonians Again

17 But since we were deprived of you, brethren, for a short time, in person not in heart, we endeavored the more eagerly and with great desire to see you face to face; **18**because we wanted to come to you—I, Paul, * again and again—but Satan hindered us. **19**For what is our hope or joy or crown of boasting before our Lord Jesus at his coming? Is it not you? **20**For you are our glory and joy.

3 Therefore when we could bear it no longer, we were willing to be left behind at Athens alone, **2**and we sent Timothy, our brother and God's servant in the gospel of Christ, to establish you in your faith and to exhort you, **3**that no one be moved by these afflictions. You yourselves know that this is to be our lot. **4**For when we were with you, we told you beforehand that we were to suffer affliction; just as it has come to pass, and as you know. **5**For this reason, when I could bear it no longer, I sent that I might

know your faith, for fear that somehow the tempter had tempted you and that our labor would be in vain.

Timothy's Good Report

6 But now that Timothy has come to us from you, and has brought us the good news of your faith and love and reported that you always remember us kindly and long to see us, as we long to see you—7for this reason, brethren, in all our distress and affliction we have been comforted about you through your faith; 8for now we live, if you stand fast in the Lord. 9For what thanksgiving can we render to God for you, for all the joy which we feel for your sake before our God, 10praying earnestly night and day that we may see you face to face and supply what is lacking in your faith?

11 Now may our God and Father himself, and our Lord Jesus, direct our way to you; 12and may the Lord make you increase and abound in love to one another and to all men, as we do to you, 13so that he may establish your hearts unblamable in holiness before our God and Father, at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all his saints.

A Life Pleasing to God

4 Finally, brethren, we beg and exhort you in the Lord Jesus, that as you learned from us how you ought to walk and to please God, just as you are doing, you do so more and more. 2For you know what instructions we gave you through the Lord Jesus. 3For this is the will of God, your sanctification: * that you abstain from immorality; * 4/sup>that each one of you know how to control his own body in holiness and honor, 5not in the passion of lust like heathens who do not know God; 6that no man transgress, and wrong his brother in this matter,c because the Lord is an avenger in all these things, as we solemnly forewarned you. 7For God has not called us for uncleanness, but in holiness. 8Therefore whoever disregards this, disregards not man but God, who gives his Holy Spirit to you.

9 But concerning love of the brethren you have no need to have any one write to you, for you yourselves have been taught by God to love one another; 10and indeed you do love all the brethren throughout Macedonia. But we exhort you, brethren, to do so more and more, 11to aspire to live quietly, to mind your own affairs, and to work with your hands, as we

charged you; * 12so that you may command the respect of outsiders, and be dependent on nobody.

The Coming of the Lord

13 But we would not have you ignorant, brethren, concerning those who are asleep, that you may not grieve as others do who have no hope. * 14For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so, through Jesus, God will bring with him those who have fallen asleep. 15For this we declare to you by the word of the Lord, that we who are alive, who are left until the coming of the Lord, shall not precede those who have fallen asleep. 16For the Lord himself will descend from heaven with a cry of command, with the archangel's call, and with the sound of the trumpet of God. And the dead in Christ will rise first; 17then we who are alive, who are left, shall be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air; and so we shall always be with the Lord. * 18Therefore comfort one another with these words.

5 But as to the times and the seasons, brethren, you have no need to have anything written to you. 2For you yourselves know well that the day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night. 3When people say, "There is peace and security," then sudden destruction will come upon them as labor pains come upon a woman with child, and there will be no escape. 4But you are not in darkness, brethren, for that day to surprise you like a thief. 5For you are all sons of light and sons of the day; we are not of the night or of darkness. 6So then let us not sleep, as others do, but let us keep awake and be sober. 7For those who sleep sleep at night, and those who get drunk are drunk at night. 8But, since we belong to the day, let us be sober, and put on the breastplate of faith and love, and for a helmet the hope of salvation. 9For God has not destined us for wrath, but to obtain salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ, 10who died for us so that whether we wake or sleep we might live with him. 11Therefore encourage one another and build one another up, just as you are doing.

Final Exhortations, Greetings,and Benediction

12 But we beg you, brethren, to respect those who labor among you and are over you in the Lord and admonish you, 13and to esteem them very highly in love because of their work. Be at peace among yourselves.c2 14And we exhort you, brethren, admonish the idle, encourage the

faintheartedness, help the weak, be patient with them all. [15]See that none of you repays evil for evil, but always seek to do good to one another and to all. [16]Rejoice always, [17]pray constantly, [18]give thanks in all circumstances; for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus for you. [19]Do not quench the Spirit, [20]do not despise prophesying, [21]but test everything; hold fast what is good, [22]abstain from every form of evil.

23 May the God of peace himself sanctify you wholly; and may your spirit and soul and body be kept sound and blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. [24]He who calls you is faithful, and he will do it.

25 Brethren, pray for us.

26 Greet all the brethren with a holy kiss.

27 I adjure you by the Lord that this letter be read to all the brethren.

28 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

2 Thessalonians

Chapters

1 2 3

THE SECOND LETTER OF PAUL TO THE THESSALONIANS

Salutation

1 Paul, Silva'nus, and Timothy,

To the Church of the Thessalo'nians in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:

2 Grace to you and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Thanksgiving

3 We are bound to give thanks to God always for you, brethren, as is fitting, because your faith is growing abundantly, and the love of every one of you for one another is increasing. 4Therefore we ourselves boast of you in the churches of God for your steadfastness and faith in all your persecutions and in the afflictions which you are enduring.

The Judgment at Christ's Coming

5 This is evidence of the righteous judgment of God, that you may be made worthy of the kingdom of God, for which you are suffering—6since indeed God deems it just to repay with affliction those who afflict you, 7and to grant rest with us to you who are afflicted, when the Lord Jesus is revealed from heaven with his mighty angels in flaming fire, 8inflicting vengeance upon those who do not know God and upon those who do not obey the gospel of our Lord Jesus. 9They shall suffer the punishment of eternal destruction and exclusion from the presence of the Lord and from the glory of his might, 10when he comes on that day to be glorified in his saints, and to be marveled at in all who have believed, because our testimony to you was believed. 11To this end we always pray for you, that our God may make you worthy of his call, and may fulfil every good resolve and work of faith by his power, 12so that the name of our Lord Jesus may be glorified in you, and you in him, according to the grace of our God and the Lord Jesus Christ.

The Man of Lawlessness

2 Now concerning the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ and our assembling to meet him, we beg you, brethren, 2not to be quickly shaken in mind or excited, either by spirit or by word, or by letter purporting to be from us, to the effect that the day of the Lord has come. * 3Let no one deceive you in any way; for that day will not come, unless the rebellion comes first, and the man of lawlessness[a] * is revealed, the son of perdition,

4 who opposes and exalts himself against every so-called god or object of
worship, so that he takes his seat in the temple of God, proclaiming himself
to be God. 5 Do you not remember that when I was still with you I told you
this? 6 And you know what is restraining him now so that he may be
revealed in his time. 7 For the mystery of lawlessness is already at work;
only he who now restrains it will do so until he is out of the way. * 8 And
then the lawless one will be revealed, and the Lord Jesus will slay him with
the breath of his mouth and destroy him by his appearing and his coming.
9 The coming of the lawless one by the activity of Satan will be with all
power and with pretended signs and wonders, 10 and with all wicked
deception for those who are to perish, because they refused to love the truth
and so be saved. 11 Therefore God sends upon them a strong delusion, to
make them believe what is false, 12 so that all may be condemned who did
not believe the truth but had pleasure in unrighteousness.

Chosen for Salvation

13 But we are bound to give thanks to God always for you, brethren
beloved by the Lord, because God chose you from the beginning b to be
saved through sanctification by the Spirit c and belief in the truth. 14 To this
he called you through our gospel, so that you may obtain the glory of our
Lord Jesus Christ. 15 So then, brethren, stand firm and hold to the traditions
which you were taught by us, either by word of mouth or by letter.

16 Now may our Lord Jesus Christ himself, and God our Father, who
loved us and gave us eternal comfort and good hope through grace,
17 comfort your hearts and establish them in every good work and word.

Request for Prayer

3 Finally, brethren, pray for us, that the word of the Lord may speed on
and triumph, as it did among you, 2 and that we may be delivered from
wicked and evil men; for not all have faith. 3 But the Lord is faithful; he will
strengthen you and guard you from evil. d 4 And we have confidence in the
Lord about you, that you are doing and will do the things which we
command. 5 May the Lord direct your hearts to the love of God and to the
steadfastness of Christ.

Warning against Idleness

6 Now we command you, brethren, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ,
that you keep away from any brother who is walking in idleness and not in

accord with the tradition that you received from us. [7]For you yourselves know how you ought to imitate us; we were not idle when we were with you, [8]we did not eat any one's bread without paying, but with toil and labor we worked night and day, that we might not burden any of you. [9]It was not because we have not that right, but to give you in our conduct an example to imitate. [10]For even when we were with you, we gave you this command: If any one will not work, let him not eat. [11]For we hear that some of you are walking in idleness, mere busybodies, not doing any work. [12]Now such persons we command and exhort in the Lord Jesus Christ to do their work in quietness and to earn their own living. [13]Brethren, do not be weary in well-doing.

14 If any one refuses to obey what we say in this letter, note that man, and have nothing to do with him, that he may be ashamed. **15**Do not look on him as an enemy, but warn him as a brother.

Final Greetings and Benediction

16 Now may the Lord of peace himself give you peace at all times in all ways. The Lord be with you all.

17 I, Paul, write this greeting with my own hand. This is the mark in every letter of mine; it is the way I write. [18]The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all.

1 Timothy

Chapters

1 2 3 4 5 6

THE FIRST LETTER OF PAUL TO TIMOTHY

Salutation

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by command of God our Savior and of
Christ Jesus our hope,

2 To Timothy, my true child in the faith: *

Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

Warning against False Teachers

3 As I urged you when I was going to Macedonia, remain at Ephesus that
you may charge certain persons not to teach any different doctrine, **4**nor to
occupy themselves with myths and endless genealogies * which promote
speculations rather than the divine training[a] that is in faith; **5**whereas the
aim of our charge is love that issues from a pure heart and a good
conscience and sincere faith. **6**Certain persons by swerving from these have
wandered away into vain discussion, **7**desiring to be teachers of the law,
without understanding either what they are saying or the things about which
they make assertions.

8 Now we know that the law is good, if any one uses it lawfully,
9understanding this, that the law is not laid down for the just but for the
lawless and disobedient, for the ungodly and sinners, for the unholy and
profane, for murderers of fathers and murderers of mothers, for manslayers,
10immoral persons, sodomites, kidnapers, liars, perjurers, and whatever else
is contrary to sound doctrine, **11**in accordance with the glorious gospel of
the blessed God with which I have been entrusted.

Gratitude for Mercy

12 I thank him who has given me strength for this, Christ Jesus our Lord,
because he judged me faithful by appointing me to his service, **13**though I
formerly blasphemed and persecuted and insulted him; but I received mercy
because I had acted ignorantly in unbelief, **14**and the grace of our Lord
overflowed for me with the faith and love that are in Christ Jesus. **15**The
saying is sure and worthy of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the
world to save sinners. And I am the foremost of sinners; **16**but I received
mercy for this reason, that in me, as the foremost, Jesus Christ might
display his perfect patience for an example to those who were to believe in
him for eternal life. **17**To the King of ages, immortal, invisible, the only
God, be honor and glory for ever and ever.[b] Amen.

18 This charge I commit to you, Timothy, my son, in accordance with the
prophetic utterances which pointed to you, that inspired by them you may
wage the good warfare, [19]holding faith and a good conscience. By rejecting
conscience, certain persons have made shipwreck of their faith, [20]among
them Hymenae'us and Alexander, whom I have delivered to Satan * that
they may learn not to blaspheme.

Instructions concerning Prayer

2 First of all, then, I urge that supplications, prayers, intercessions, and
thanksgivings be made for all men, [2]for kings and all who are in high
positions, that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life, godly and respectful
in every way. [3]This is good, and it is acceptable in the sight of God our
Savior, [4]who desires all men to be saved and to come to the knowledge of
the truth. [5]For there is one God, and there is one mediator between God and
men, the man Christ Jesus, [6]who gave himself as a ransom for all, * the
testimony to which was given at the proper time. [7]For this I was appointed a
preacher and apostle (I am telling the truth, I am not lying), a teacher of the
Gentiles in faith and truth.

8 I desire then that in every place the men should pray, lifting holy hands
without anger or quarreling; [9]also that women should adorn themselves
modestly and sensibly in seemly apparel, not with braided hair or gold or
pearls or costly attire [10]but by good deeds, as befits women who profess
religion. [11]Let a woman learn in silence with all submissiveness. [12]I permit
no woman to teach or to have authority over men; she is to keep silent.
[13]For Adam was formed first, then Eve; [14]and Adam was not deceived, but
the woman was deceived and became a transgressor. [15]Yet woman will be
saved through bearing children,[c] if she continues[d] in faith and love and
holiness, with modesty.

Qualifications of Bishops

3 The saying is sure: If any one aspires to the office of bishop, * he
desires a noble task. [2]Now a bishop must be above reproach, the husband of
one wife, temperate, sensible, dignified, hospitable, an apt teacher, [3]no
drunkard, not violent but gentle, not quarrelsome, and no lover of money.
[4]He must manage his own household well, keeping his children submissive
and respectful in every way; [5]for if a man does not know how to manage his

own household, how can he care for God's Church? 6He must not be a
recent convert, or he may be puffed up with conceit and fall into the
condemnation of the devil;[f] 7moreover he must be well thought of by
outsiders, or he may fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.[f]

Qualifications of Deacons

8 Deacons likewise must be serious, not double-tongued, not addicted to
much wine, not greedy for gain; 9they must hold the mystery of the faith
with a clear conscience. 10And let them also be tested first; then if they
prove themselves blameless let them serve as deacons. 11The women [*]
likewise must be serious, no slanderers, but temperate, faithful in all things.
12Let deacons be the husband of one wife, and let them manage their
children and their households well; 13for those who serve well as deacons
gain a good standing for themselves and also great confidence in the faith
which is in Christ Jesus.

The Mystery of Our Religion

14 I hope to come to you soon, but I am writing these instructions to you
so that, 15if I am delayed, you may know how one ought to behave in the
household of God, which is the Church of the living God, the pillar and
bulwark of the truth. 16Great indeed, we confess, is the mystery of our
religion:

He[h] was manifested in the flesh,
vindicated[i] in the Spirit,
  seen by angels,
preached among the nations,
believed on in the world,
  taken up in glory.

False Asceticism

4 Now the Spirit expressly says that in later times some will depart from
the faith by giving heed to deceitful spirits and doctrines of demons,
2through the pretensions of liars whose consciences are seared, 3who forbid
marriage * and enjoin abstinence from foods [*] which God created to be
received with thanksgiving by those who believe and know the truth. 4For
everything created by God is good, and nothing is to be rejected if it is
received with thanksgiving; 5for then it is consecrated by the word of God
and prayer.

A Good Minister of Jesus Christ

6 If you put these instructions before the brethren, you will be a good
minister of Christ Jesus, nourished on the words of the faith and of the good
doctrine which you have followed. [7]Have nothing to do with godless and
silly myths. Train yourself in godliness; [8]for while bodily training is of
some value, godliness is of value in every way, as it holds promise for the
present life and also for the life to come. [9]The saying is sure and worthy of
full acceptance. [10]For to this end we toil and strive,[j] because we have our
hope set on the living God, who is the Savior of all men, especially of those
who believe.

11 Command and teach these things. [12]Let no one despise your youth, but
set the believers an example in speech and conduct, in love, in faith, in
purity. [13]Till I come, attend to the public reading of Scripture, to preaching,
to teaching. [14]Do not neglect the gift you have, which was given you by
prophetic utterance when the elders laid their hands upon you. [15]Practice
these duties, devote yourself to them, so that all may see your progress.
[16]Take heed to yourself and to your teaching; hold to that, for by so doing
you will save both yourself and your hearers.

Duties toward Believers

5 Do not rebuke an older man but exhort him as you would a father;
treat younger men like brothers, [2]older women like mothers, younger
women like sisters, in all purity.

3 Honor widows who are real widows. * [4]If a widow has children or
grandchildren, let them first learn their religious duty to their own family
and make some return to their parents; for this is acceptable in the sight of
God. [5]She who is a real widow, and is left all alone, has set her hope on
God and continues in supplications and prayers night and day; [6]whereas she
who is self-indulgent is dead even while she lives. [7]Command this, so that
they may be without reproach. [8]If any one does not provide for his relatives,
and especially for his own family, he has disowned the faith and is worse
than an unbeliever.

9 Let a widow be enrolled if she is not less than sixty years of age, having
been the wife of one husband; [10]and she must be well attested for her good
deeds, as one who has brought up children, shown hospitality, washed the
feet of the saints, relieved the afflicted, and devoted herself to doing good in

every way. 11But refuse to enrol younger widows; for when they grow wanton against Christ they desire to marry, 12and so they incur condemnation for having violated their first pledge. * 13Besides that, they learn to be idlers, gadding about from house to house, and not only idlers but gossips and busybodies, saying what they should not. 14So I would have younger widows marry, bear children, rule their households, and give the enemy no occasion to revile us. 15For some have already strayed after Satan. 16If any believing woman[l] has relatives who are widows, let her assist them; let the Church not be burdened, so that it may assist those who are real widows.

17 Let the elders who rule well be considered worthy of double honor, especially those who labor in preaching and teaching; 18for the Scripture says, “You shall not muzzle an ox when it is treading out the grain,” and, “The laborer deserves his wages.” 19Never admit any charge against an elder except on the evidence of two or three witnesses. 20As for those who persist in sin, rebuke them in the presence of all, so that the rest may stand in fear. 21In the presence of God and of Christ Jesus and of the elect angels I charge you to keep these rules without favor, doing nothing from partiality. 22Do not be hasty in the laying on of hands, nor participate in another man’s sins; keep yourself pure.

23 No longer drink only water, but use a little wine for the sake of your stomach and your frequent ailments.

Men’s Deeds, False Teaching,and True Riches

24 The sins of some men are conspicuous, pointing to judgment, but the sins of others appear later. 25So also good deeds are conspicuous; and even when they are not, they cannot remain hidden.

6 Let all who are under the yoke of slavery regard their masters as worthy of all honor, so that the name of God and the teaching may not be defamed. 2Those who have believing masters must not be disrespectful on the ground that they are brethren; rather they must serve all the better since those who benefit by their service are believers and beloved.

Teach and urge these duties. 3If any one teaches otherwise and does not agree with the sound words of our Lord Jesus Christ and the teaching which accords with godliness, 4he is puffed up with conceit, he knows nothing; he has a morbid craving for controversy and for disputes about words, which

produce envy, dissension, slander, base suspicions, [5]and wrangling among men who are depraved in mind and bereft of the truth, imagining that godliness is a means of gain. [6]There is great gain in godliness with contentment; [7]for we brought nothing into the world, and[m] we cannot take anything out of the world; [8]but if we have food and clothing, with these we shall be content. [9]But those who desire to be rich fall into temptation, into a snare, into many senseless and hurtful desires that plunge men into ruin and destruction. [10]For the love of money is the root of all evils; it is through this craving that some have wandered away from the faith and pierced their hearts with many pangs.

The Good Fight of Faith

11 But as for you, man of God, shun all this; aim at righteousness, godliness, faith, love, steadfastness, gentleness. [12]Fight the good fight of the faith; take hold of the eternal life to which you were called when you made the good confession in the presence of many witnesses. [13]In the presence of God who gives life to all things, and of Christ Jesus who in his testimony before Pontius Pilate made the good confession, [14]I charge you to keep the commandment unstained and free from reproach until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ; [15]and this will be made manifest at the proper time by the blessed and only Sovereign, the King of kings and Lord of lords, [16]who alone has immortality and dwells in unapproachable light, whom no man has ever seen or can see. To him be honor and eternal dominion. Amen.

17 As for the rich in this world, charge them not to be haughty, nor to set their hopes on uncertain riches but on God who richly furnishes us with everything to enjoy. [18]They are to do good, to be rich in good deeds, liberal and generous, [19]thus laying up for themselves a good foundation for the future, so that they may take hold of the life which is life indeed.

Personal Instructions and Benediction

20 O Timothy, guard what has been entrusted to you. Avoid the godless chatter and contradictions of what is falsely called knowledge, [21]for by professing it some have missed the mark as regards the faith.

Grace be with you.

2 Timothy

Chapters

1 2 3 4

THE SECOND LETTER OF PAUL TO TIMOTHY

Salutation

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God according to the promise of the life which is in Christ Jesus,

2 To Timothy, my beloved child:

Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

Thanksgiving and Encouragement

3 I thank God whom I serve with a clear conscience, as did my fathers, when I remember you constantly in my prayers. **4**As I remember your tears, I long night and day to see you, that I may be filled with joy. **5**I am reminded of your sincere faith, a faith that dwelt first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and now, I am sure, dwells in you. **6**For this reason I remind you to rekindle the gift of God that is within you through the laying on of my hands; **7**for God did not give us a spirit of timidity but a spirit of power and love and self-control.

8 Do not be ashamed then of testifying to our Lord, nor of me his prisoner, but take your share of suffering for the gospel in the power of God, **9**who saved us and called us with a holy calling, not in virtue of our works but in virtue of his own purpose and the grace which he gave us in Christ Jesus ages ago, **10**and now has manifested through the appearing of our Savior Christ Jesus, who abolished death and brought life and immortality to light through the gospel. **11**For this gospel I was appointed a preacher and apostle and teacher, **12**and therefore I suffer as I do. But I am not ashamed, for I know whom I have believed, and I am sure that he is able to guard until that Day what has been entrusted to me.[a] **13**Follow the pattern of the sound words which you have heard from me, in the faith and love which are in Christ Jesus; **14**guard the truth that has been entrusted to you by the Holy Spirit who dwells within us.

15 You are aware that all who are in Asia * turned away from me, and among them Phy'gelus and Hermog'enes. **16**May the Lord grant mercy to the household of Onesiph'orus, for he often refreshed me; he was not ashamed of my chains, **17**but when he arrived in Rome he searched for me eagerly and found me—**18**may the Lord grant him to find mercy from the Lord on that Day—and you well know all the service he rendered at Ephesus.

A Good Soldier of Christ

2 You then, my son, be strong in the grace that is in Christ Jesus, [2]and what you have heard from me before many witnesses entrust to faithful men who will be able to teach others also. [3]Take your share of suffering as a good soldier of Christ Jesus. [4]No soldier on service gets entangled in civilian pursuits, since his aim is to satisfy the one who enlisted him. [5]An athlete is not crowned unless he competes according to the rules. [6]It is the hard-working farmer who ought to have the first share of the crops. [7]Think over what I say, for the Lord will grant you understanding in everything.

8 Remember Jesus Christ, risen from the dead, descended from David, as preached in my gospel, [9]the gospel for which I am suffering and wearing chains like a criminal. But the word of God is not chained. [10]Therefore I endure everything for the sake of the elect, that they also may obtain the salvation which in Christ Jesus goes with eternal glory. [11]The saying is sure:

If we have died with him, we shall also live with him;
[12]if we endure, we shall also reign with him;
if we deny him, we also will deny us;
[13]if we are faithless, he remains faithful—
for he cannot deny himself.

A Workman Approved by God

14 Remind them of this, and charge them before the Lord[b] to avoid disputing about words, which does no good, but only ruins the hearers. [15]Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a workman who has no need to be ashamed, rightly handling the word of truth. [16]Avoid such godless chatter, for it will lead people into more and more ungodliness, [17]and their talk will eat its way like gangrene. Among them are Hymenae'us and Phile'tus, [18]who have swerved from the truth by holding that the resurrection is past already. * They are upsetting the faith of some. [19]But God's firm foundation stands, bearing this seal: "The Lord knows those who are his," and, "Let every one who names the name of the Lord depart from iniquity."

20 In a great house there are not only vessels of gold and silver but also of wood and earthenware, and some for noble use, some for ignoble. [21]If any one purifies himself from what is ignoble, then he will be a vessel for noble use, consecrated and useful to the master of the house, ready for any good

work. 22So shun youthful passions and aim at righteousness, faith, love, and peace, along with those who call upon the Lord from a pure heart. 23Have nothing to do with stupid, senseless controversies; you know that they breed quarrels. 24And the Lord's servant must not be quarrelsome but kindly to every one, an apt teacher, forbearing, 25correcting his opponents with gentleness. God may perhaps grant that they will repent and come to know the truth, 26and they may escape from the snare of the devil, after being captured by him to do his will.[c]

Godlessness in the Last Days

3 But understand this, that in the last days there will come times of stress. 2For men will be lovers of self, lovers of money, proud, arrogant, abusive, disobedient to their parents, ungrateful, unholy, 3inhuman, implacable, slanderers, profligates, fierce, haters of good, 4treacherous, reckless, swollen with conceit, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, 5holding the form of religion but denying the power of it. Avoid such people. 6For among them are those who make their way into households and capture weak women, burdened with sins and swayed by various impulses, 7who will listen to anybody and can never arrive at a knowledge of the truth. 8As Jan'nes and Jam'bres opposed Moses, so these men also oppose the truth, men of corrupt mind and counterfeit faith; 9but they will not get very far, for their folly will be plain to all, as was that of those two men.

Paul's Charge to Timothy

10 Now you have observed my teaching, my conduct, my aim in life, my faith, my patience, my love, my steadfastness, 11my persecutions, my sufferings, what befell me at Antioch, at Ico'nium, and at Lystra, what persecutions I endured; yet from them all the Lord rescued me. 12Indeed all who desire to live a godly life in Christ Jesus will be persecuted, 13while evil men and impostors will go on from bad to worse, deceivers and deceived. 14But as for you, continue in what you have learned and have firmly believed, knowing from whom you learned it 15and how from childhood you have been acquainted with the Sacred Writings which are able to instruct you for salvation through faith in Christ Jesus. 16All Scripture is inspired by God and[d] profitable for teaching, for reproof, for

correction, and for training in righteousness, * 17that the man of God may be complete, equipped for every good work.

4 I charge you in the presence of God and of Christ Jesus who is to judge the living and the dead, and by his appearing and his kingdom: 2preach the word, be urgent in season and out of season, convince, rebuke, and exhort, be unfailing in patience and in teaching. 3For the time is coming when people will not endure sound teaching, but having itching ears they will accumulate for themselves teachers to suit their own likings, 4and will turn away from listening to the truth and wander into myths. 5As for you, always be steady, endure suffering, do the work of an evangelist, fulfil your ministry.

6 For I am already on the point of being sacrificed; * the time of my departure has come. 7I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. 8From now on there is laid up for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous judge, will award to me on that Day, and not only to me but also to all who have loved his appearing.

Personal Instructions

9 Do your best to come to me soon. 10For Demas, in love with this present world, has deserted me and gone to Thessaloni'ca; Crescens has gone to Galatia,[e] Titus to Dalmatia. 11Luke alone is with me. Get Mark and bring him with you; for he is very useful in serving me. 12Tych'icus I have sent to Ephesus. 13When you come, bring the cloak that I left with Carpus at Tro'as, also the books, and above all the parchments. 14Alexander the coppersmith did me great harm; the Lord will pay him back for his deeds. 15Beware of him yourself, for he strongly opposed our message. 16At my first defense no one took my part; all deserted me. May it not be charged against them! 17But the Lord stood by me and gave me strength to proclaim the word fully, that all the Gentiles might hear it. So I was rescued from the lion’s mouth. 18The Lord will rescue me from every evil and save me for his heavenly kingdom. To him be the glory for ever and ever. Amen.

Final Greetings and Benediction

19 Greet Prisca and Aqui'la, and the household of Onesiph'orus. 20Eras'tus remained at Corinth; Troph'imus I left ill at Mile'tus. 21Do your best to come before winter. Eubu'lus sends greetings to you, as do Pudens and Linus * and Claudia and all the brethren.

22 The Lord be with your spirit. Grace be with you.

Titus

Chapters

1 2 3

THE LETTER OF PAUL TO TITUS

Salutation

1 Paul, a servant[a] of God and an apostle of Jesus Christ, to further the
faith of God's elect and their knowledge of the truth which accords with
godliness, **2**in hope of eternal life which God, who never lies, promised ages
ago **3**and at the proper time manifested in his word through the preaching
with which I have been entrusted by command of God our Savior;

4 To Titus, my true child in a common faith:
Grace and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Savior.

Titus in Crete

5 This is why I left you in Crete, that you might amend what was
defective, and appoint elders * in every town as I directed you, **6**if any man
is blameless, the husband of one wife, and his children are believers and not
open to the charge of debauchery and not being insubordinate. **7**For a
bishop, as God's steward, must be blameless; he must not be arrogant or
quick-tempered or a drunkard or violent or greedy for gain, **8**but hospitable,
a lover of goodness, master of himself, upright, holy, and self-controlled;
9he must hold firm to the sure word as taught, so that he may be able to give
instruction in sound doctrine and also to confute those who contradict it.
10For there are many insubordinate men, empty talkers and deceivers,
especially the circumcision party; **11**they must be silenced, since they are
upsetting whole families by teaching for base gain what they have no right
to teach. **12**One of themselves, a prophet of their own, said, "Cretans are
always liars, evil beasts, lazy gluttons." **13**This testimony is true. Therefore
rebuke them sharply, that they may be sound in the faith, **14**instead of giving
heed to Jewish myths or to commands of men who reject the truth. **15**To the
pure all things are pure, but to the corrupt and unbelieving nothing is pure;
their very minds and consciences are corrupted. **16**They profess to know
God, but they deny him by their deeds; they are detestable, disobedient,
unfit for any good deed.

Teach Sound Doctrine

2 But as for you, teach what befits sound doctrine. **2**Bid the older men
be temperate, serious, sensible, sound in faith, in love, and in steadfastness.
3Bid the older women likewise to be reverent in behavior, not to be
slanderers or slaves to drink; they are to teach what is good, **4**and so train

the young women to love their husbands and children, [5]to be sensible, chaste, domestic, kind, and submissive to their husbands, that the word of God may not be discredited. [6]Likewise urge the younger men to control themselves. [7]Show yourself in all respects a model of good deeds, and in your teaching show integrity, gravity, [8]and sound speech that cannot be censured, so that an opponent may be put to shame, having nothing evil to say of us. [9]Bid slaves to be submissive to their masters and to give satisfaction in every respect; they are not to talk back, [10]nor to pilfer, but to show entire and true fidelity, so that in everything they may adorn the doctrine of God our Savior.

11 For the grace of God has appeared for the salvation of all men, [12]training us to renounce irreligion and worldly passions, and to live sober, upright, and godly lives in this world, [13]awaiting our blessed hope, the appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior[c] * Jesus Christ, [14]who gave himself for us to redeem us from all iniquity and to purify for himself a people of his own who are zealous for good deeds.

15 Declare these things; exhort and reprove with all authority. Let no one disregard you.

Maintain Good Deeds

3 Remind them to be submissive to rulers and authorities, to be obedient, to be ready for any honest work, [2]to speak evil of no one, to avoid quarreling, to be gentle, and to show perfect courtesy toward all men. [3]For we ourselves were once foolish, disobedient, led astray, slaves to various passions and pleasures, passing our days in malice and envy, hated by men and hating one another; [4]but when the goodness and loving kindness of God our Savior appeared, [5]he saved us, not because of deeds done by us in righteousness, but in virtue of his own mercy, by the washing of regeneration and renewal in the Holy Spirit, [6]which he poured out upon us richly through Jesus Christ our Savior, [7]so that we might be justified by his grace and become heirs in hope of eternal life. * [8]The saying is sure.

I desire you to insist on these things, so that those who have believed in God may be careful to apply themselves to good deeds;[d] these are excellent and profitable to men. [9]But avoid stupid controversies, genealogies, dissensions, and quarrels over the law, for they are unprofitable and futile. [10]As for a man who is factious, after admonishing him once or twice, have

nothing more to do with him, [11]knowing that such a person is perverted and sinful; he is self-condemned.

Final Messages and Benediction

12 When I send Ar'temas or Tych'icus to you, do your best to come to me at Nicop'olis, for I have decided to spend the winter there. [13]Do your best to speed Ze'nas the lawyer and Apol'los on their way; see that they lack nothing. [14]And let our people learn to apply themselves to good deeds,[d] so as to help cases of urgent need, and not to be unfruitful.

15 All who are with me send greetings to you. Greet those who love us in the faith.

Grace be with you all.

THE LETTER OF PAUL TO PHILEMON

Salutation

1 Paul, a prisoner for Christ Jesus, and Timothy our brother,

To Phile'mon our beloved fellow worker **2**and Ap'phia our sister and Archip'pus our fellow soldier, and the church in your house:

3 Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Philemon's Love and Faith

4 I thank my God always when I remember you in my prayers, **5**because I hear of your love and of the faith which you have toward the Lord Jesus and all the saints, **6**and I pray that the sharing of your faith may promote the knowledge of all the good that is ours in Christ. **7**For I have derived much joy and comfort from your love, my brother, because the hearts of the saints have been refreshed through you.

Paul's Plea for Onesimus

8 Accordingly, though I am bold enough in Christ to command you to do what is required, **9**yet for love's sake I prefer to appeal to you—I, Paul, an ambassador[a] and now a prisoner also for Christ Jesus—**10**I appeal to you for my child, Ones'imus,[b] whose father I have become in my imprisonment. **11**(Formerly he was useless to you, but now he is indeed useful to you and to me.) **12**I am sending him back to you, sending my very heart. **13**I would have been glad to keep him with me, in order that he might serve me on your behalf during my imprisonment for the gospel; **14**but I preferred to do nothing without your consent in order that your goodness might not be by compulsion but of your own free will.

15 Perhaps this is why he was parted from you for a while, that you might have him back for ever, **16**no longer as a slave but more than a slave, as a beloved brother, especially to me but how much more to you, both in the flesh and in the Lord. **17**So if you consider me your partner, receive him as you would receive me. **18**If he has wronged you at all, or owes you anything, charge that to my account. **19**I, Paul, write this with my own hand, I will repay it—to say nothing of your owing me even your own self. **20**Yes, brother, I want some benefit from you in the Lord. Refresh my heart in Christ.

21 Confident of your obedience, I write to you, knowing that you will do even more than I say. **22**At the same time, prepare a guest room for me, for I am hoping through your prayers to be granted to you.

Final Greetings and Benediction

23 Ep'aphras, my fellow prisoner in Christ Jesus, sends greetings to you,
24 and so do Mark, Aristar'chus, Demas, and Luke, my fellow workers.
25 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit.